5 Additional objects and experimental design

The square demonstrated one equilibrium solution. We now propose comparisons of geometry, mesh size, loading and supports to test how widely its behaviour applies. These are experiment specifications, not findings or an agreed final selection of objects.

5.1 Objects and shared physical settings

We retain the unit square as a control and propose two additional objects (Fig. 1). The longer rectangle tests the effect of increasing the distance between support and load. The perforated square tests removing material while keeping the outer boundary fixed. We compare both deformation and solver effort. Both changes also alter material area, so neither isolates shape at constant area.

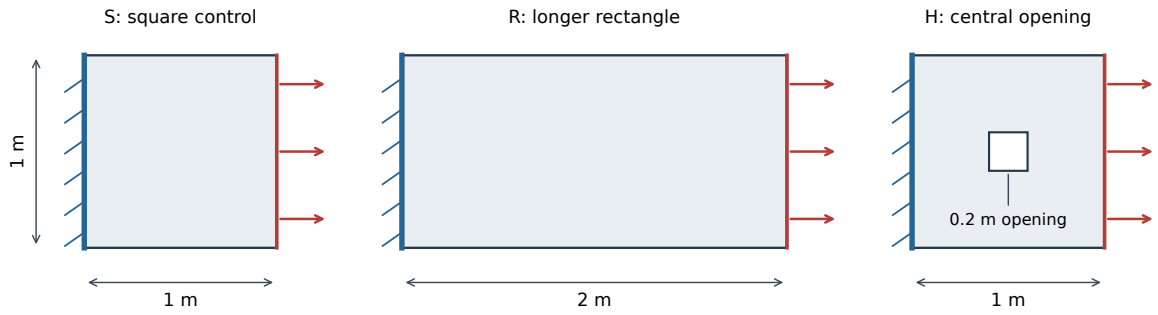

Figure 1: Proposed geometries at a common scale, in metres, not meshes or deformations. Blue edges are clamped in both directions; arrows indicate uniform rightward traction on red edges. Other edges are free.

Coordinates are in metres. The square's outer boundary is $(0,0),(1,0),(1,1),(0,1)$; the rectangle's is $(0,0),(2,0),(2,1),(0,1)$. The perforated square retains the first boundary and adds the opening $(0.4,0.4),(0.4,0.6),(0.6,0.6),(0.6,0.4)$. Outer vertices run counterclockwise, hole vertices clockwise, and each list closes back to its first vertex. The opening is empty space, not a softer material.

All baseline cases retain Section 4's plane-stress settings: $E = 200$ GPa, $\nu = 0.3$, $t = 0.01$ m, no body force and zero displacement in both directions along the whole left edge. Uniform rightward traction $p = 100$ MPa acts on the whole right edge. Each edge is one metre high, giving the same total force $F_0 = 10^6$ N. Other boundaries are traction-free. Material and thickness stay fixed throughout.

5.2 Meshes that preserve the physical case

We propose Triangle's boundary-constrained meshing through its Python interface, as introduced in Section 2 [1]. All three objects, including the square control, will use this route; Section 4's structured mesh is therefore a separate demonstration, not a matched-mesh geometry comparison. We request a minimum triangle angle of 25° and maximum triangle areas of 0.005, 0.00125 and 0.0003125 m^2. These are area limits, not guaranteed edge lengths or error bounds. Equal area limits need not give equal numbers of unknowns.

Boundary segments, holes and load/support endpoints must be preserved. Edge forces are integrated as in Section 2, not assigned equally per node, so refinement preserves the physical loading. Before solving, we check positive triangle areas, boundary coverage, an empty opening and one connected solid region. Both support choices below fix at least two distinct points

in both directions, preventing translations and rotation. We check the supported matrix and record element counts, free unknowns and mesh quality. The companion case specification supplies boundary splits, a hole seed and mesher options.

5.3 Controlled comparisons and recorded responses

Table 1 defines the comparisons. Except under refinement, we use the middle area limit. Load and support studies reuse each object's mesh, changing only the named factor from the baseline.

Table 1: Proposed case register, using fixed material and thickness and Section 3's protocol. Outcomes belong in Section 6.

Study	Changed factor	Question and fixed quantities
Geometry	Square, rectangle, perforated square	How do response and solver cost change at fixed traction, clamp and mesh-area limit?
Mesh	Three area limits, on each object	Do displacement measures settle under refinement of the same physical case?
Magnitude	$0.5F_0$, F_0, $1.5F_0$ on each object	Does displacement scale with load when its location, mesh and supports are fixed?
Location	Lower, middle or upper right-edge patch on each object	How does moving the same total force affect deformation at fixed mesh and clamp?
Supports	Full left clamp or central half-clamp on each object	How does releasing part of the boundary affect response at fixed mesh and full-edge load?

For the location study, each patch is 0.25 m high: its vertical interval is $[0, 0.25]$, $[0.375, 0.625]$ or $[0.75, 1]$ m. Each carries F_0 rightward, so its uniform traction is $F_0/(0.25\,\mathrm{m}\,t) = 400$ MPa; the rest of the edge is unloaded. Comparing these three equal-length patches isolates location. Comparing a patch with the full-edge baseline would also change load concentration. The shorter clamp fixes both components on the left-edge interval $[0.25, 0.75]$ m and leaves the rest of that edge traction-free. Its physical length stays fixed under refinement, not its number of nodes.

We record mean horizontal displacement along the whole right edge and displacement at its midpoint, comparing the same physical locations across meshes. The mean is edge-length weighted, not a node average. Deformed outlines will state units and amplification. Solver measurements follow Section 3; conditioning estimates follow Section 2 and are not inferred from displacement size. Magnitude scaling at fixed stiffness checks linearity, not directional load sensitivity, which requires a separately specified perturbation test.

Each case needs Section 4's support and force/moment-balance checks. Refinement measures mesh dependence, not error against an exact solution. Sharp corners and boundary-condition changes can concentrate stress; peak corner stresses are therefore excluded as convergence measures. Physical interpretation still requires checking the small-strain assumptions. Object selection and Section 2's assembly-routine permission remain open.

References

[1] Jonathan Richard Shewchuk, *Triangle: Generating Delaunay triangulations*, Carnegie Mellon University, Triangle documentation, `https://www.cs.cmu.edu/~quake/triangle.delaunay.html`.